Northbridge University — Scholarship Rules

Office of Student Financial Aid · Academic Year 2026–2027 · Document SFA-101

1. Overview

Northbridge University offers three institutional scholarships to undergraduate students: the Merit Scholarship, the Need-Based Grant and the Sports Scholarship. Each scholarship has its own eligibility requirements, award amounts and application deadline. All scholarships are awarded for one academic year and must be renewed annually.

2. Application Deadlines

- Merit Scholarship: applications close on March 15 for the following academic year.
- Need-Based Grant: applications close on April 30 for the following academic year.
- Sports Scholarship: nominations are submitted by the Athletics Department by May 31.

Late applications are not considered, except where the Scholarship Committee grants an extension for documented medical emergencies.

3. How to Apply

1. Log in to the Student Portal and open the "Financial Aid" tab.
2. Complete the online Scholarship Application Form (form SFA-1).
3. Upload your most recent official transcript.
4. For the Need-Based Grant, also upload the Family Income Statement (form SFA-3).
5. Submit the application before the deadline. You will receive a confirmation email within 2 working days.

4. Merit Scholarship — Eligibility Requirements

The Merit Scholarship recognises outstanding academic performance. To be eligible, a student must meet ALL of the following requirements:

- The student must be in their second year of study or above. First-year students are not eligible for the Merit Scholarship.
- The student must have a cumulative GPA of at least 3.5 on a 4.0 scale.
- The student must be enrolled full-time (at least 12 credits per semester).

Students who meet these requirements are considered automatically once they submit the application form; no interview is required.

5. Need-Based Grant — Eligibility Requirements

The Need-Based Grant supports students whose families have limited financial means. To be eligible, a student must:

- have an annual family income below $50,000, as shown on form SFA-3, and
- have a cumulative GPA of at least 2.5.

Students in any year of study, including first-year students, may apply for the Need-Based Grant.

6. Award Amounts

Merit Scholarship awards depend on the student's cumulative GPA:

Merit tier	Cumulative GPA	Annual award
Silver	3.50 – 3.79	$2,000
Gold	3.80 – 4.00	$4,000

The Need-Based Grant is a fixed $3,000 per academic year. Sports Scholarship amounts are set by the Athletics Department and range from $1,000 to $5,000 per year.

7. Key Differences Between Scholarships

The Merit Scholarship is based only on academic results (GPA and year of study) and is not affected by family income. The Need-Based Grant is based mainly on family income and only requires a minimum GPA of 2.5. The Merit Scholarship is only open to second-year students and above, while the Need-Based Grant is open to all years.

8. Combining Scholarships

- A student who holds a Sports Scholarship may also receive the Merit Scholarship, provided the combined total of both awards does not exceed the student's annual tuition fee.
- The Merit Scholarship and the Need-Based Grant cannot be held at the same time. A student eligible for both receives whichever award is higher.
- A student may hold at most two institutional scholarships at any time.

9. Renewal

Scholarships are renewed each year only if the student continues to meet the eligibility requirements at the end of the spring semester.

10. Appeals

A student who disagrees with a scholarship decision may appeal:

1. Submit a written appeal using form SFA-9 within 14 calendar days of the decision email.
2. Attach any supporting documents (for example corrected transcripts or medical certificates).
3. The Scholarship Committee reviews appeals at its monthly meeting and responds in writing within 30 days.

The Committee's decision on an appeal is final.